5.2.1 Factors to be considered while selecting a site for the construction of a house

i. Physical Features

a) The site should be regular in shape and should have exact boundaries marked on the land.

b) A low lying ground is unhealthy because it is capable of causing dampness during rainy season and it becomes a breeding place for flies and mosquitoes.

c) The site should be on an elevated ground for drainage of water especially during rainy season.

d) A site on an elevated ground gives wider and brighter view of the house. Site which faces South/North direction is preferable.

ii. Soil Conditions

a) The best soil is one where soft soil is at the surface and hard soil beneath 3 or 4 ft.

b) A mixture of sand and gravel is good.

c) Rocky surfaces afford good foundation, but poses difficulty while levelling or excavating the ground due to its hardness. On rocky surface, laying drainage pipe is very costly. Besides, it is not suitable for growing plants.

d) Clay and sandy soils are unsuitable because clay surface holds water for a long time and sandy soil absorbs water.

iii. Sanitary Facilities

a) There should be no stagnant pools or water tanks and unused wells around the site.

b) The site should not be surrounded by public drainage and toilet.

c) The site should not be selected near cattle sheds, poultry farm and factories for health reasons.

d) Reclaimed land filled with debris and refuse is unhealthy for building purposes, as it will give out obnoxious gases. During rainy season it becomes a good breeding place for flies and mosquitoes.

e) The site should have fresh air, ample lighting and good water supply.

f) A site in a busy locality may not be suitable for health reasons because of dust and the constant smoke from vehicles.

g) A site with modern sanitary facilities is the most suitable.

iv. Practical Convenience

a) The value of the site depends upon the convenience available around it.

b) The site should be within easy reach to school, market, bank, hospital or nursing home, railway station, bus terminus and post office.

v. Good Neighbourhood

a) The site should be selected near a developed area for safety.

b) Good neighbourhood adds to the permanent happiness of the family.

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